

HCS 2026 Preparation Guide

Haryana Civil Services (HCS) — Syllabus, Exam Pattern, Books, Online Coaching & Preparation Strategy

Important: This guide is based on the revised HCS syllabus/pattern discussed above. The official Haryana Government notification should be treated as the controlling source for the latest examination rules.

1. Official HCS Syllabus

The revised HCS syllabus notification was issued by the Haryana Government Personnel Department on 7 January 2026 (Notification No. 42/1/2018-5SII). The official government PDF should be kept as the master syllabus.

Official Haryana Government syllabus: <https://csharyana.gov.in/WriteReadData/Notifications-%26-Orders/Services-II/15732.pdf>

Reference PDF mirror: https://parikshasarathi.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/01/Haryana-HPSC-HCS-Syllabus-2026_cropped.pdf

2. HCS Exam Structure — Revised Pattern

Prelims

Paper	Subject	Marks	Nature
I	General Studies	100	Merit/screening
II	CSAT	100	Qualifying; 33%

Both papers are objective and are 2 hours each. The current rules discussed above include 0.25 negative marking and an Option-E rule for questions not attempted. CSAT requires 33% and Prelims marks are not added to final merit.

Mains

Paper	Subject	Marks
I	English + English Essay	100
II	Hindi + Hindi Essay	100
III	General Studies-I	100
IV	General Studies-II	100
V	General Studies-III	100
VI	General Studies-IV — Ethics	100

Mains total: 600 marks. Interview: 75 marks. The revised pattern has no optional subject. The rules discussed above specify 45% aggregate in Mains and 33% each in English and Hindi for qualification for the Personality Test.

3. Prelims — General Studies Syllabus

History

- Ancient and medieval Indian history
- Modern Indian history
- Indian National Movement and freedom struggle
- Social, economic and political aspects of Indian history

Geography

- Indian and world geography
- Physical, social and economic geography
- Agriculture and natural resources

Indian Polity

- Constitution
- Political system
- Panchayati Raj
- Governance and political institutions

Economy

- Indian economy
- Economic development
- Major economic developments
- Social and economic systems

Science

- General science and everyday science
- Basic Physics, Chemistry and Biology
- Scientific developments and applications

General Mental Ability

- Reasoning
- Analytical ability
- Logical thinking

Haryana

- Haryana economy
- People and society
- Social, economic and cultural institutions
- Language and Haryana-specific issues

4. CSAT

Reading comprehension; interpersonal/communication skills; logical reasoning; analytical ability; decision making; problem solving; general mental ability; basic numeracy; data interpretation; charts, graphs and tables. Numeracy is broadly at Class 10 level.

5. Mains Syllabus

GS-I — History, Culture, Society & Geography

- Indian culture, art, literature and architecture
- Modern Indian history, freedom struggle and post-independence India
- World history, Industrial Revolution, World Wars, colonisation/decolonisation and political philosophies
- Indian society: diversity, women, population, poverty, urbanisation, globalisation, communalism, regionalism and secularism
- World physical geography, natural resources, industrial location and major geographical phenomena
- Haryana-related issues

GS-II — Polity, Governance & International Relations

- Indian Constitution, constitutional development, amendments and basic structure
- Centre-State relations, federalism, devolution and local government
- Parliament, State Legislature, Executive, Judiciary, constitutional/statutory/regulatory bodies
- Governance, government policies, welfare schemes, health, education, poverty and social justice
- E-governance, transparency, accountability and RTI
- India's neighbourhood, international organisations and groupings
- Haryana-related governance and policy issues

GS-III — Economy, Agriculture, Science, Environment & Security

- Indian economy, growth, development, employment and inclusive growth
- Budgeting, agriculture, cropping patterns, irrigation, MSP, subsidies, PDS and food security
- Animal husbandry, food processing, land reforms, industrial policy and infrastructure
- Energy, science and technology, IT, space, biotechnology, nanotechnology and IPR
- Environment, biodiversity, pollution, climate and disaster management
- Internal security, cybersecurity, money laundering, organised crime and border security
- Haryana-related issues

GS-IV — Ethics

- Ethics and human interface; human values; ethical behaviour
- Attitude and emotional intelligence
- Integrity, impartiality, objectivity, empathy, tolerance and compassion
- Moral thinkers and philosophers
- Public service values and ethics in public administration
- Probity, RTI, codes of ethics/conduct, Citizen's Charter, work culture and corruption
- Ethics case studies

6. English & Hindi

English: Precis writing, comprehension, grammar, vocabulary, usage, composition, essay writing, clear and concise expression.

Hindi: Comprehension, grammar, precis, translation, idioms, sentence correction, prose/poetry explanation, composition and essay.

7. Recommended Books

Area	Recommended resources
History	NCERT History 6–12; Spectrum — A Brief History of Modern India
Polity	M. Laxmikanth — Indian Polity
Geography	NCERT Geography 6–12; G.C. Leong — Certificate Physical & Human Geography
Economy	NCERT Economics 9–12; Ramesh Singh — Indian Economy
Environment	Shankar IAS — Environment
Science	NCERT Science 6–10
CSAT	TMH CSAT Manual OR Arihant CSAT
Haryana GK	Arihant — Know Your State: Haryana; a current Haryana GK compilation
Current Affairs	The Hindu OR Indian Express; one monthly compilation such as Vision IAS, Drishti IAS or StudyIQ

Do not buy multiple books for the same subject. Use one primary source, revise it repeatedly, and add PYQs/current affairs.

8. Haryana-Specific Preparation

- Haryana history, geography, culture and language
- Haryana economy, agriculture and industries
- Haryana government schemes and policies
- Haryana Budget and Economic Survey
- Demography, social indicators and important personalities
- Sports and major state developments
- Haryana current affairs
- Haryana examples for Mains answers

Because Haryana-related issues appear across Mains GS-I, GS-II and GS-III in the revised structure, Haryana preparation should run throughout the year rather than being postponed until Prelims.

9. Online Coaching Shortlist

Institute	How to use it
Dr Amit Academy	Integrated HCS preparation covering Prelims, CSAT, Haryana GK, current affairs, Mains GS papers, English
Chetan Bharat Learning (CBL)	Haryana/HCS-focused online preparation with live/recorded classes, MCQs, answer-writing, tests and mocks
Drishti IAS	Useful particularly for Mains resources, answer writing/test series and current affairs. Can supplement a

Course links referenced in the earlier research: Dr Amit Academy — <https://dramitacademy.com/> ; CBL HCS course — <https://www.chetanbharat.com/verticals/single/upsc/course/801> ; Drishti HCS resources — <https://www.drishtias.com/hindi/state-pcs/hr-state-pcs/hcs-mains-syllabus>

Before paying, check: revised syllabus coverage, faculty stability, number of tests, Mains evaluation quality, Haryana-specific current affairs, recorded-class access, doubt support and validity period.

10. Suggested Preparation Strategy

Phase	Duration	Focus
1 — Foundation	3–4 months	NCERTs, Laxmikanth, basic Haryana GK, basic current affairs, CSAT twice weekly
2 — Standard books	3–4 months	Spectrum, Ramesh Singh, G.C. Leong, Shankar IAS, Haryana material, Ethics; start PYQs
3 — Mains integration	Parallel	10/15-marker answers, essays, ethics case studies, Haryana examples, English/Hindi
4 — Prelims intensive	Last 3–4 months	PYQs, Haryana GK, current affairs, full mocks, CSAT, revision and elimination practice

11. Recommended Minimal Resource Set

- NCERTs — History, Geography, Economy, Science
- Laxmikanth — Indian Polity
- Spectrum — Modern Indian History
- Ramesh Singh — Indian Economy
- G.C. Leong — Geography
- Shankar IAS — Environment
- Haryana GK book + Haryana Budget/Economic Survey
- One newspaper + one monthly current-affairs source
- HCS previous-year papers
- One test series and regular Mains answer-writing practice

12. Important Note on Old HCS Material

Older HCS preparation videos/books may describe an optional-subject Mains structure. For preparation under the revised 2026 pattern, use the current official notification and syllabus as the controlling documents and ensure any coaching course is explicitly updated for the new six-paper compulsory Mains structure.

Prepared as a consolidated HCS preparation guide from the information provided in the preceding discussion. Verify dates, rules, fees and course availability against the latest official HPSC/Haryana Government notification before making exam or purchase decisions.